gāh). Two roads from Andar-āb joined it at its main pass, which led to Parwān. This road was quite challenging.

From Ghūr-bund, three roads led over the mountains. The one closest to Parwān was called the Yāngī-yūl pass (New-road), leading to Khinjan. Above it was the Qīpchāq road, crossing where the waters of Andar-āb met the Sūrkh-āb (Qīzīl-sū), offering an excellent route. The third road passed over the Shibr-tū pass. Those crossing it in the warmer months continued through Bamyan and Saighān, while winter travelers took the path through Āb-dara (Water-valley). Shibr-tū was the exception, as it remained open year-round.

With the exception of Shibr-tū, all the Hindū-kush roads were closed for three or four months in winter due to impassable valley-bottoms when waters ran high. Attempting to traverse the Hindū-kush by going over the mountains during this period proved exceptionally challenging. The optimal time for crossing was during the three or four months of autumn when snow was less, and water levels were lower. Highwaymen, including Kāfir, were a constant concern whether traveling on the mountains or in the valley-bottoms.

The road from Kābul to Khurāsān passed through Qandahār, offering a level route without any mountain passes. Four roads led into Kābul from the Hindustan side. One passed through a relatively low Khyber mountain pass, another through Bangash, and another through Naghr (or Naghz), all with low passes. These roads were accessible from three ferries over the Sind. Those who took the Nīl-āb ferry continued through the Lamghānāt. In winter, some forded the Sind-water (at Hāru) above its confluence with the Kābul-water and crossed by foot. Most of Babur’s journeys into Hindustan involved using these fords, except during his last expedition in AD 1525, when he defeated Sultan Ibrāhīm and had crossed the Nīl-āb by boat. The Sind-water was generally passable by boat, except at the mentioned location. Those who crossed at Dīn-kot continued through Bangash, while those crossing at Chaupāra, taking the Farmūl road, continued to Ghaznī or, if following the Dasht route, proceeded to Qandahār.

f. Inhabitants of Kābul

The Kābul country was home to numerous diverse tribes. In its valleys and plains, one could find Turks and clansmen, along with Arabs. The town and many villages were inhabited by Sārts, while the districts and other